Rescues & Cats

I'm often asked 'Do they get on with cats?' In bullet point form here is the answer.

- Most chained & abandoned dogs have lived around cats & many of them. There are more cats than dog's here even, though the difference is that they are tolerated & fed & people less cruel to them.
- Cats are abandoned too here & breed in their scores as they think neutering is against nature and god
- In all the time I've rescued I've never seen an abandoned dog chase a cat. I've seen dogs once rescued & happier chase cats they don't know on walks for example though not to hurt
- The dogs here are starving. If a dog emaciated to the point of near death doesn't instinctively try to save their own lives via a ready supply of prey such as cats then that is the answer to your question
- Most of the pooches I rescue & help are disinterested in cats
- They cohabitate with them & are very indifferent to their presence
- They are often eating food scraps with cats joining in or very close by
- If a dog wants to kill a cat they'd be dead within minutes. Dogs don't have to 'try' - if they wanted to 'eat' a cat they would succeed.
- I come from a family that's had cats all their life. Any pooch that wants to kill a cat is extremely rare. It is normal and instinctive for dogs to want to chase cats- not all dogs but

some.

- I also have rescue dogs & cats where I live and I have trained them to cohabitate in harmony like you would a resident cat in a pet shop that lives with the hamsters and birds without noticing them but will chase a bird it hasn't met before.
- When animals kill it is mainly because they are mothers protecting babies, have an extreme physical trauma like a brain tumour for example or out of fear
- I'm not saying it doesn't happen- but the dogs here are starving and not one of them are even chasing a cat let alone trying to hurt them
- It isn't about animals never causing harm to one another because there are always exceptions in life- one dog I adopted was terrorised by the resident cat for a while before things calmed down.
- It's about understanding that as an owner you are an integral part of the introduction & thus an influencing factor in how it develops and most importantly how you interpret their behaviour.
- People shouldn't have their cats frightened but they shouldn't be too nervous either.
- For example the cats here have a room to themselves that is dog free upstairs with the door open. The dogs could go up there but don't.
- Below is a screen shot/message from one of my owners who adopted a Siberian Husky & owns 7 cats
- Adopters should expect new dogs to possibly chase cats in play until they get used to each other. The cats might stay outside for a while. This is normal. We would do the same possibly
- They soon get used to the fact that there is a new family member in their pack.
- By the same token they might live in

harmony. They might ignore each other

- When you ask ‘do they get on with cats’ the answer could be ‘yes but they haven’t met yours yet’. You have to give them chance to get to know each other as animals in their own right
- We offer plenty of support in introducing new family members sensibly whether it’s a house lead, cat shelves higher than dogs can reach &/or baby gates. You can also chat to owners with experience in socialising cats with dogs successfully including 5 cats with a Siberian husky. They are happy to advise. Please ask the rescue for details
- This attachment is a guideline when you’re adopting from me. It is relevant in its context & not intended to be an exhaustive study on every interaction between cats & dogs
- Pictures & videos we can forward show you better than I can ever tell you

In an owners words
Gail Mackenzie
“Leesa Mckenna when Skye first arrived he (& like all dogs going to a new home) had alot to take in. His first instinct during the first week when getting to know the cats...was to chase them. Let's face it cats are fast & interesting creatures, Skye I'm sure thought the same. He didn't really know what to do so we helped him to understand. Didn't take long for him to realise they are part of the family & no longer chases them. They run past him, jump over him & he doesn't budge 👍
when no humans are in the house they are separated in different parts of the home, at the start was part of the learning process

but is now so the cats can eat, drink & sleep in peace without any of the dogs eating their food or steaking their beds 😂"